

UNDERSTAND · INVESTIGATE · INTERPRET

A guide to PA-X peace agreement data

Discover what PA-X records, find the agreements that matter to your question, and understand how to interpret them.

For researchers, students, practitioners, country teams and people encountering PA-X for the first time.

Three connected layers of evidence

Agreement text

What was agreed?



Coded metadata

Where, when, who, which process?

Coded provisions

What issues does it address?



Your research question

Find · Read · Compare · Interpret

Peace agreement data for research and policy

PA-X brings peace agreement texts together with information about their context and expert coding of their content. It supports both close reading and investigation of patterns across agreements and processes.

Developed by researchers at the University of Edinburgh through PeaceRep, it helps mediators, civic actors, policy teams and researchers explore how agreements address conflict. [\[1\]](#)

2,257

agreements in main PA-X

1990–2025

agreement coverage

**Read +
analyse**

documents, metadata and provisions

v10 (2026)

The agreement record

PA-X uses the agreement as its basic unit. Its text, context and provisions give you different ways to find and understand it.

EXPLORE THE DOCUMENT COLLECTION

Browse PA-X agreements visually

The PA-X corpus viewer brings agreement documents together on a visual timeline. Start with the collection as a whole, filter by recorded metadata, then zoom into individual documents.

Orient by date.

The Time view positions agreements by when they were signed.

Narrow the collection.

Use the metadata filters to explore places, conflict classifications or agreement stages.

Inspect a document.

Zoom into its first-page image and open its details for links to the PDF and PA-X record.

The images show the first page of the English-language document or translation. The original PDFs and PA-X records provide the document detail. Developed for PA-X by Tomas Vancisin and Niamh Henry, using VIKUS Viewer.

Explore online: [PA-X corpus viewer](#).

A REAL AGREEMENT / PA-X 152

Acuerdo Final entre el Gobierno Nacional y el Partido Revolucionario de los Trabajadores, don Gabriel, Ovejas, Sucre

25 January 1991

[Open the agreement record](#)

01

Agreement text

The agreement text sets out the commitments. Read the original document and its coded passages.

02

Agreement context

Colombia / Colombia I - Gaviria process

AgtId = 152 PP = 97

03

Coded provisions

Rebels transitioning to political parties

PolParTrans = 1

[Read the topic definition](#)

Illustrated record using agreement 152 and its main CSV values. The document shape is a visual guide, not a reproduction of the agreement.

01

The agreement

A document with a name, date and connection to a peace process.

A stable identifier

AgtId in the CSV is also the number in the website record address: `/agreements/152/`.

Name and date

Agt and Dat

The process it belongs to

PP and PPName identify its peace process.

02

Coded metadata

Information that situates the agreement within a conflict and peace process.

Type and stage

Interstate, intrastate or local; stage and substage; agreement status.

Location

Country/entity, region and location identifiers, including ISO and GWNO codes where available.

Signatories

Part and ThrdPart record parties and third parties as listed in the agreement.

03

Coded provisions

Expert coding helps you find agreements and passages on an issue without reading every document first.

Subjects include

Governance, gender, security, power sharing, groups and transitional justice.

Explore the detail

Move from a broad topic to more specific kinds of provision.

[Browse all topics and descriptions →](#)

Field meanings and classifications: [3]. Search labels and CSV names are shown together in the [terminology reference](#).

Agreement locations and dates

The [agreement map and timeline](#) shows where and when agreements are recorded, with visual summaries of their coded content. Use it to orient your question before opening individual records.

PA-X collections and resources

Start with the collection closest to your question. Specialist collections add a different focus or more detail.



Main PA-X

Includes: agreement texts, contextual information and coding across substantive issues.

Use it to: find commitments, follow a peace process, or compare carefully defined groups of agreements.

Remember: what a document promises and what later happens are different questions.

[Search agreements](#) ↗ · [Data and codebook](#) ↗



PA-X Gender

Includes: agreements with provisions on women, girls, gender or sexual violence, with more detailed gender coding.

Use it to: distinguish participation, equality, protection and other kinds of gender-related commitment.

Remember: a gender-focused collection cannot show the share of all agreements that mention gender without also considering the wider collection.

[Search gender provisions](#) ↗ · [Explore its topics](#) → · [Data and codebook](#) ↗



PA-X Local

Includes: documented agreements addressing local issues, involving local actors and local or communal conflict.

Use it to: explore local peacemaking and its relationship to wider processes.

Remember: informal, unwritten or unavailable agreements are not all captured. The collection is not a census of local peacemaking.

[Search local agreements](#) ↗ · [Explore the map](#) ↗ · [Data and codebook](#) ↗



PAA-X Actors

Includes: structured actor information and signing relationships linked to PA-X agreements.

Use it to: work with structured signatory records across agreements, where the original documents may use different names, titles or references for an actor.

Remember: signatories do not capture everyone who negotiated, influenced or participated in a process.

[Explore the published dataset](#) ↗
[Explore an actor network in Tracker](#)

Searching and analysing agreement text

On [PA-X Search](#), use **Agreement text (free text search)** to search the body of agreement documents. Combine this with location, date or topic filters to focus your selection.

For text analysis in your own tools, download the **PA-X Corpus** and connect it to the quantitative data using [AgId](#). The dedicated Excel Corpus file splits long documents across columns.

Corpus data and codebook

[Browse the agreement collection visually](#) to move from the collection overview to individual document images and records.

 About this field

Country/entity

`Con` identifies the country or jurisdiction in which the conflict originated, or the entity to which a territorial conflict relates. For interstate agreements addressing interstate conflict, PA-X lists the states signing or publicly agreeing the agreement.

 About this field

Parties and third parties

`Part` and `ThrdPart` preserve names as written in the agreement. Third-party roles, such as witness or guarantor, follow the document wording. PA-X adds explanatory notes for unsigned documents and other special cases.

Names, titles and references can vary across documents. Use [PAA-X](#) for structured signatory data and explore [signatory networks in Tracker](#).

Collection descriptions: [\[2\]](#); actor resource: [\[7\]](#).

Visualisations and analytical tools

Messy Peace Processes

Explore how agreement stages unfold through a process, then return to the source agreements. Chart movement does not measure progress or success.

[Explore process sequences ↗](#)

PA-X Local Agreements Map

Explore the geography of documented local agreements. Concentrations on a map also reflect which documents could be collected.

[Explore local agreements ↗](#)

Gender insights

Explore a visual account of gender-related provisions. Read what each chart counts and the selection it covers.

[Explore gender insights ↗](#)

Third-party involvement

Investigate recorded third-party involvement across agreements. A signing role alone does not establish influence or effectiveness.

[Explore third-party patterns ↗](#)

PA-X Tracker: signatory networks

Explore connections between agreements and their party and third-party signatories. Select an actor to investigate the agreements they signed, or an agreement to see its signatories. Tracker also brings agreement information alongside contextual indicators.

[Explore the Afghanistan actor network](#)
[Browse Tracker countries / Guidance and sources](#)

Provenance of Peacebuilding

Explore the collection, language work, coding and review behind the data, and how it supports further research.

[Explore how PA-X is made ↗](#)

CONNECT YOUR DATA

Linking PA-X to other datasets

Use the recorded identifiers below to link datasets. Keep `AgtId` with your results so each match can be traced to its PA-X agreement.

Dataset or code system	PA-X CSV columns	What to match
UCDP	<code>UcdpCon</code> / <code>UcdpAgr</code>	Match <code>UcdpCon</code> to the conflict identifier (<code>conflict_id</code>), and <code>UcdpAgr</code> to the peace agreement identifier (paid in the UCDP Peace Agreement Dataset v19.1). Choose the appropriate UCDP dataset and version.
Peace Accords Matrix (PAM)	<code>PamAgr</code>	Match the recorded PAM agreement identifier to the agreement ID in your chosen PAM export. Confirm the agreement name and date; PAM focuses on comprehensive agreements.
Correlates of War	<code>CowWar</code>	Match the recorded war number to the war-number field in the relevant COW war dataset. Several PA-X agreements can relate to the same war.
ISO country codes	<code>Loc1ISO</code> / <code>Loc2ISO</code>	Match the three-letter country designation to an ISO alpha-3 column, such as COL for Colombia. Include the relevant year when joining country-year data.
Gleditsch-Ward country codes	<code>Loc1GWN0</code> / <code>Loc2GWN0</code>	Match the numeric Gleditsch-Ward country code, such as 100 for Colombia. Check historical state coverage and the year of your observations.

Prepare the merge: align identifier formats (for example, `100.0` and `100`), retain missing values as missing, and check repeated IDs before joining. A match can produce several rows per agreement, especially with country-year or event data. Choose the time period and unit of analysis explicitly. The location slots indicate the recorded locations; assignment to slot 1 or 2 does not rank their importance.

[PA-X linking-field definitions](#) / [UCDP agreement identifiers](#) / [Explore the metadata fields](#)

How PA-X data is produced

PA-X combines documentary research, substantive expertise and quality review. Click + on each step to see what the work involves, or open the full provenance visualisation.

Which agreements are included?

PA-X's core definition concerns formal, publicly available documents agreed by some or all conflict protagonists and aimed at addressing conflict. The collection begins in 1990. Expert judgement is needed when applying these conditions. A variety of documents are archived and excluded from the main PA-X release.

The documented time rule covers agreements signed after 1 January 1990 addressing an ongoing conflict, or one that ended within the preceding 50 years. This includes some settlements reached long after fighting ended. [Read the methodology explanation \(p.26\) ?](#)

The core conflict threshold is more than 25 conflict-related deaths in a year. PA-X also includes some local agreements outside that threshold. Agreement status can cover clearly agreed documents without conventional signatures, so a handwritten signature is not a universal entry requirement.

[Read the full inclusion guidance ↗](#) · [Read definitions and status rules ↗](#)

1 Collect

Peace agreement collection is an ongoing process that compiles documents from a wide range of sources, including official websites, NGO reports, books, news monitoring, social media, word of mouth and correspondence. Researchers draw on expertise in law and international relations.

Recurring challenges include missed and non-written agreements, source bias, verifying information and deciding whether an agreement should be included.

[See which agreements are included](#)

2 Translate

Peace agreements are often written in local languages. In these cases, domain and language experts translate the documents into English, drawing on interpretation, translation, legal terminology and country-specific context.

Translation involves careful attention to meaning, including the risk of translation errors and misinterpretation.

3 Transcribe

Agreements come in various formats, including PDFs, Word documents and images. Their text often needs to be transcribed into plain text using optical character recognition (OCR), hand-typing, copy-and-paste or automated extraction.

Transcription work addresses typographical errors, duplicate text, tables, handwriting and the removal of personal information.

4 Code

The plain text of the agreement is tagged according to the topics it covers, including socio-economic development, political or military power sharing, and gender. This work draws on expertise in political science, country context, conflict resolution, law and international relations.

Coding questions include missed passages, missing data, interpretation of the coding manual and differences between coders.

5 Quality control

The tagged text goes through quality control to ensure that coding is consistent with the definitions of the topics. Reviewers with expertise in PA-X coding and context resolve coding questions and review decisions made during coding.

This includes checking untagged passages, missing data, coding inconsistencies and adherence to the coding manual.

6 Publish

Once the data is approved and quality checks are resolved, it is published in the PA-X database. Preparing a release brings together software engineering, database management and web development, using manual entry and automated processing.

The published data supports further research, specialist coding, visualisations and other PeaceTech resources.

[Explore the provenance visualisation](#)

Understanding PA-X terminology

Agreement metadata

Stage, type, status, process and location describe its context. Learn their meanings and the labels you will see in Search and CSV files.



Agreement 152

Colombia / 25 January 1991

Agreement name	Agt
Acuerdo Final entre el Gobierno Nacional y el Partido Revolucionario de los Trabajadores, don Gabriel, Ovejas, Sucre	
Country/entity	Con
Colombia	
Agreement stage	Stage
Framework-substantive, comprehensive	SubComp
Peace process	PPName
Colombia I - Gaviria	

Metadata places this agreement in context. Select a field to read its definition.

Explore agreement information →

Agreement content and topic coding

Topic coding helps identify what the text says. Read descriptions, what is included or excluded, and how a topic divides into more specific topics.

FROM A BROAD TOPIC TO A SPECIFIC PROVISION

CATEGORY

Governance

Gov

ISSUE

Political parties reform

PolPar

SUB-ISSUE

Rebels transitioning to political parties

PolParTrans

Topic coding describes what the agreement addresses. Select a topic to explore its meaning.

Search and browse topics →

STAGE IN FOCUS

Peace processes are messy

Processes go back and forth between stages. In the visualisation below, reveal the recorded trajectories and follow a peace process: talks, ceasefires, substantive agreements and implementation arrangements can recur as negotiations develop.

An implementation agreement is not proof that an agreement was implemented. It may set out arrangements for carrying out earlier commitments.

[Read the implementation-stage description →](#)

Agreement stages over time

Start with the smooth blue line showing an idealised sequence. Select CLICK TO START inside the chart to reveal the recorded, back-and-forth trajectories. Then explore a process and its agreements; Reset returns to the idealised view.

[Open the full Messy Peace Processes explorer](#)

The interactive ideal-to-messy transition is available in the web guide. Open the explorer: <https://129.215.193.6/>

Messy Peace Processes / Back and Forth in Peace Negotiations. Follow how agreement stages recur across a process. [6]

Research questions and methods

Use PA-X Search in the browser, or work with a CSV in a spreadsheet, R or Python. The question is shared; the instructions and field names differ.

Examining provisions on a specific issue

A

Example: armed groups becoming political parties.

Build this search →

Start with the meaning. Look up [Rebels transitioning to political parties](#) before choosing a filter.

On PA-X Search

1. Choose the country/entity you want.
2. Under agreement content, choose Governance, then Political parties reform and the transition sub-issue.
3. Open a result and read its coded passages alongside the agreement document.
4. Use **Export agreement coding (PDF)** to keep an evidence note; download the selected data if you want to analyse it further.

In the main CSV

Select the relevant `Con` designation and `PolParTrans = 1`. Keep `AgtId` to reconnect your rows to the website.

A REAL EXAMPLE · AGREEMENT 152

Colombia: Government and PRT agreement, 25 January 1991

The record links political-party transition coding to provisions facilitating the PRT's legal establishment as a political party. The local main CSV records `PolParTrans = 1`.

This record and its coded data provide evidence of what is written in the agreement. They do not record whether its commitments were implemented.

[Read the agreement and export its coding ↗](#)

Comparing topic coverage across agreements

[Hierarchy and Continuity in Key Issues](#) arranges agreement topics in a matrix. Sort and compare their coverage by country, region, process, stage or agreement type, then return to the text to interpret the pattern.

Tracing agreements through a peace process

B

Follow a country or a particular peace process.

Build the Sudan timeline →

On PA-X Search

Choose Country/Entity or a Peace process. Open the timeline to see the agreements over time, with the results beneath it. Use the result-order controls to inspect the list, open individual agreements, or export data for further analysis.

In the main CSV

Select `PP` for one process and confirm its `PPName`. Parse and sort `Dat`; retain `AgtId`, `Stage` and `StageSub`. A country can contain multiple processes.

Interpreting an agreement chronology

A timeline describes recorded agreement-making. Gaps do not show that negotiations stopped, and stage changes do not measure success or failure.

[Open the Sudan timeline and results ↗](#)

Institutional events surrounding agreements

Explore elections, constitutional events, coups and amnesties alongside agreements in the [Sudan Timeline of Formal Change Processes](#) on PA-X Tracker.

Use the event-type filter to focus the timeline, then open an event for its description and source links. This adds institutional context to the agreement chronology. Check each source's coverage; events occurring close together do not establish a causal relationship.

The [Sudan Tracker profile](#) also links to a process overview, implementation data, an agreement-actor network and PeaceRep research.

Tracking provision coverage over time

C

What share of non-local agreements each year contains substantive provisions on refugees or displaced persons?

Build this selection

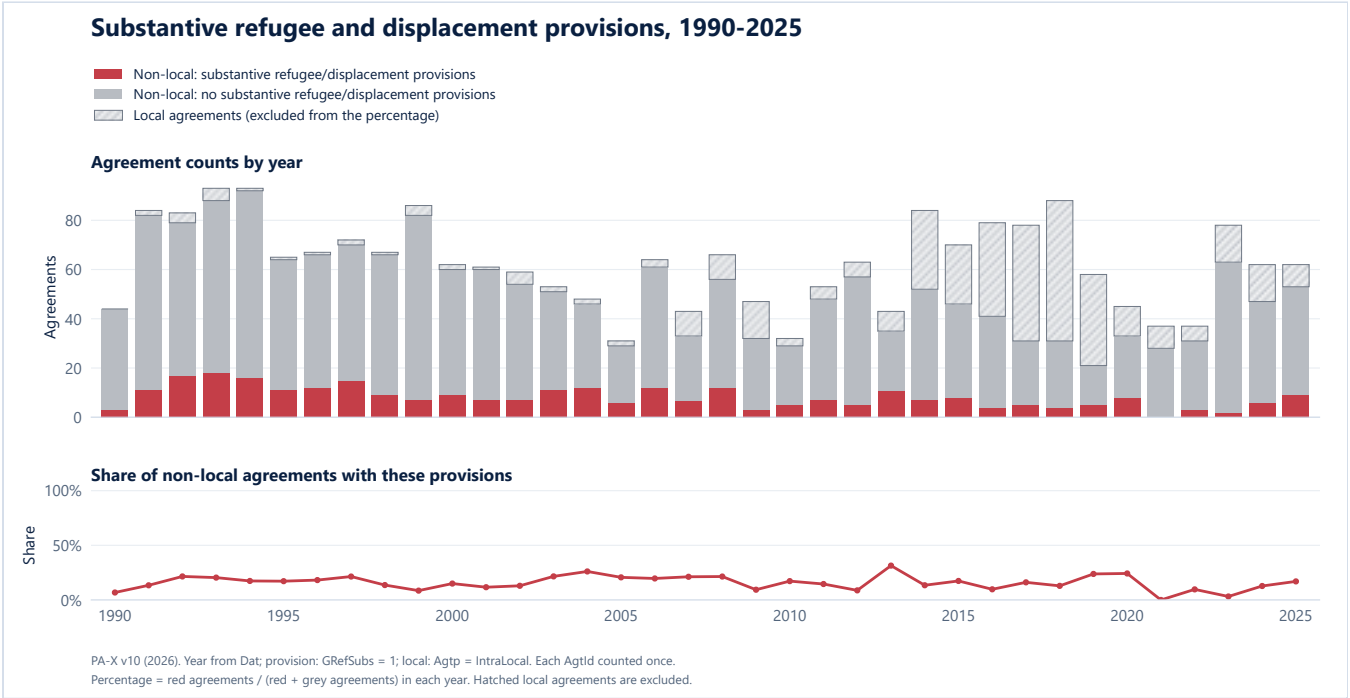
On PA-X Search

Select all agreement/conflict levels except **Intrastate/local conflict** and export the results. Then add **Refugees/displaced persons: Substantive** and export this selection too. Group each export by agreement year in a spreadsheet or analysis tool. For each year, divide the number with substantive provisions by the total number of non-local agreements. The CSV workflow below shows how to calculate this from the main dataset.

In the main CSV

1. Extract the year from `Dat` and keep one row per `AgtId`.
2. Exclude `Agtp = IntraLocal`. Group the remaining agreements by year.
3. For each year, count all remaining agreements and those with `GRefSubs = 1`. Divide the second count by the first and multiply by 100.

In a spreadsheet, add a year column and a 1/0 column for `GRefSubs = 1`. After excluding local rows, a pivot table with year as rows and the average of that 1/0 column, formatted as a percentage, gives the annual share. Include a count of `AgtId` alongside it.



Calculated from the main PA-X v10 CSV. Hatched bars on top show excluded local agreements. Red shows non-local agreements with substantive provisions; grey shows non-local agreements without substantive provisions. The percentage uses only red plus grey. Each agreement is counted once within its year.

Selection matters. This example uses `GRefSubs = 1` for substantive provisions. `GRef > 0` would answer the broader question of any coded reference, including rhetorical references. Always retain the annual counts alongside the percentages.

For 2025, 9 of 53 non-local agreements (17.0%) contain these substantive provisions. The 9 local agreements shown with hatching are excluded from that calculation.

[Download annual counts and percentages \(CSV\)](#)

[Download chart \(SVG\)](#)

[Read the topic definition](#)

Constructing a PA-X search

Choose real PA-X options. Open the resulting search in a new tab, or use the CSV instructions to select the equivalent information in your data file.

Where your choices appear on PA-X Search

The public search form starts with agreement location, then agreement content and name or date. For an issue search, choose a Country/Entity if needed, then use Category, Issue or Sub-issue to describe the provision you want to find. Advanced Filters are available below these sections.

The screenshot displays the PA-X Search interface with the following sections:

- Search by Agreement Location**: Includes dropdowns for Region, Country/Entity, and Agreements/conflict level, each with an "Include all" option.
- Search by Agreement Content**: Includes dropdowns for Category, Issue, and Sub-issue, each with an "Include all" option. Below these is a "Match any issues" section with two radio buttons: "Any of the selected categories/issues/sub-issues" (selected) and "All of the selected categories/issues/sub-issues".
- Search by Agreement Name and Date**: Includes a text input for "Agreement name" (placeholder: "Search agreements by their title") and a text input for "Agreement text (free text search)" (placeholder: "Search by body text of the agreement document"). Below these are two date range inputs labeled "Signed between date range" with a "dd/mm/yyyy" format and a calendar icon.
- Advanced Filters**: A section with a "+" icon to expand further options.
- PA-X Versions**: A section with a "+" icon to expand further options.
- At the bottom, there are two buttons: "Search" (blue) and "Reset Form" (yellow).

The PA-X Search page groups filters by agreement location, content, and name and date. Open Advanced Filters for further restrictions. Screenshot supplied during review; the query builder below uses a simplified selection of these controls.

Your PA-X search

What agreements have been recorded for Sudan over time?

1. Countries/entities (any selected): Sudan

https://www.peaceagreements.org/agreements/search/?search_type=basic-search&show_timeline=1&countries=130#timeline

The timeline is followed by the agreement results. Open a record to read or export its coding; use the results export options for further analysis.

A generated link applies your choices on PA-X. This guide does not fetch or count the resulting agreements.

The builder uses the main PA-X search. For specialist Gender or Local coding, use the links on those resource cards. Country and process restrictions combine; incompatible choices may return no agreements.

Interpreting PA-X data

Agreement text → Commitment

Outcome needs separate evidence

Agreement commitments and implementation

Text can show what parties agreed. It cannot by itself show implementation, compliance or a lasting change on the ground.

✓ Place ✓ Time ✓ Agreement type

Scope and selection

Different periods, processes and agreement types create different comparisons. Explain who or what is included and excluded.

Code = 0 → No specific mention

Interpreting the absence of a code

"No specific mention" means the text was not coded as addressing that issue. It does not show a deliberate decision to exclude it, or that it was unimportant in negotiations. Missing information is a separate matter.

A B Observed together

Association and causal inference

Topics appearing together do not show that one caused the other. Shared signatories do not establish an alliance, influence or effectiveness. Topics in one agreement may occur in different passages.

Preparing a country or policy briefing

1. **Orient yourself.** Open a country timeline, identify the relevant processes and read a few agreements.
2. **Focus on your question.** Find the relevant topic definition, then search for its provisions. Include the context needed to explain the selection.
3. **Keep the evidence.** Save agreement coding PDFs or a CSV, and note which passages support your briefing.
4. **Add research and expertise.** Read the relevant PeaceRep findings and consult country or thematic researchers about context, implementation and interpretation.
5. **Write a bounded conclusion.** Say what the agreements provide for, what your selection covers, and which questions remain unanswered.

Contextual data for a briefing

PA-X Tracker [country profiles](#) bring together available institutional timelines, process overviews, contextual indicators and agreement-actor networks. Choose the component that matches your briefing question, and check its sources and coverage.

Briefing structure

The policy question · the agreements examined · two or three relevant commitments with links · differences or exceptions · what the evidence cannot establish · questions for further research or discussion.

[Example: Sudan research findings ↗](#) · [Gender, peace and security findings ↗](#) · [Contact PeaceRep](#)

The guide supports briefings and shared learning. It does not replace conversation between researchers, policy teams, civic actors and practitioners.

Remember to cite the data

Citing PA-X gives credit to the research and expertise behind the data, identifies the resources you have used, and supports transparent, reproducible work. Follow the citation guidance and terms of use provided with the dataset or resource you use.

Copy the PA-X citation

Bell, C., & Badanjak, S. (2019). Introducing PA-X: A new peace agreement database and dataset. *Journal of Peace Research*, 56(3), 452–466. <https://www.peaceagreements.org/>

For analysis, also identify the dataset file you used, cite the appropriate codebook, and link the agreements or passages behind your findings. Specialist datasets provide their own citation instructions.

Sources used in this guide

The numbered links support explanations and examples in this guide. They are source references, not seven citations to copy into your own work.

[1] About PA-X (<https://www.peaceagreements.org/about-pax/>): purpose, audience and background.

[2] Downloads and citations (<https://www.peaceagreements.org/downloads/>): main and specialist datasets, Corpus and codebooks.

[3] PA-X Codebook v10 (https://www.peaceagreements.org/cms/documents/3956/PA_X_codebook_v10.pdf): definitions, variables and coding rules. See PDF pp.15–24 for core definitions and metadata.

[4] Provenance of Peacebuilding (<https://tvancisin.github.io/provenance/>): production activities and research expertise.

[5] PA-X Search (<https://www.peaceagreements.org/agreements/search/>): public labels, filter options and agreement records.

[6] PA-X visualisations (<https://www.peaceagreements.org/visualizations/>) and PeaceRep tools (<https://peacerep.org/peacetech-tools/>): further ways to explore the data. Back and Forth design credits: Tobias Kauer, Tomas Vancisin and Niamh Henry, PeaceRep Vis Team, University of Edinburgh.

[7] PAX public dataset record (<https://datashare.ed.ac.uk/items/8b4b563a-3993-42e1-b867-7d3b67353919>): actor data and documentation.

